

Basic bidding Notrump raises Major suit raises

This set of practice deals focuses on basic bidding situations. There are no conventions used except for one deal which uses Blackwood. Even that is optional.

The deals are designed with the beginning player in mind, or perhaps those who feel the need to refresh themselves on the fundamentals of bidding.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in finding a fit and deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam.

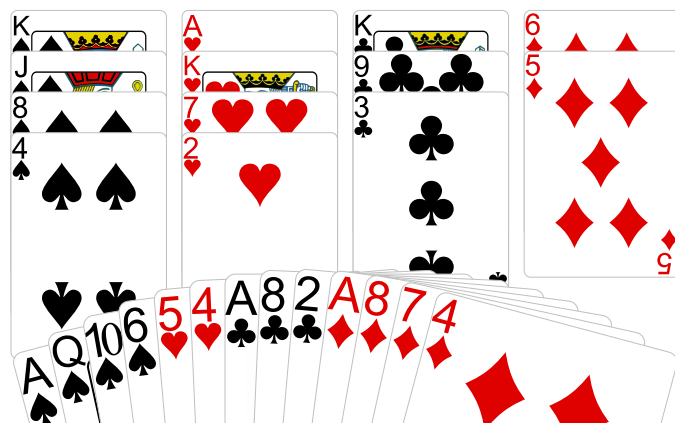
Keep in mind:

- a combined 8-card trump fit is desired to play in a suit

- it takes 26 points to make game in Notrump or a Major suit

- it takes 33 points to make small slam

Deal 1 Ctr: 4♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 2 Ctr: 4♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



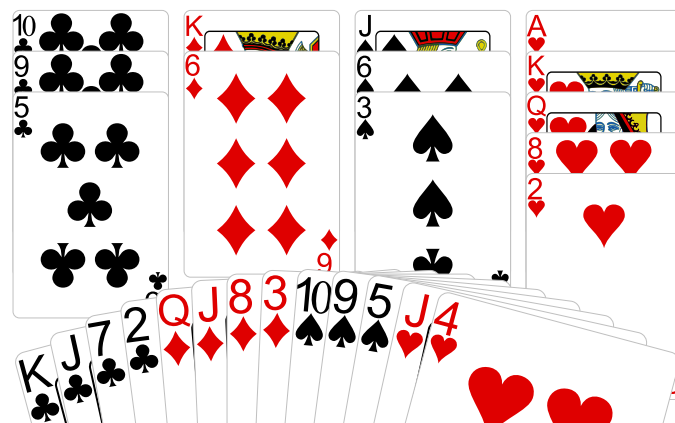
Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 3 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 4 Ctr: 1NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: East

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: South

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 1NT
Declarer: West

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 2♠
Declarer: North

Deal 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 5 3
 ♥ Q T 9 6
 ♦ K T 9
 ♣ Q T 4

14
 7 5
 14

♠ A Q T 6
 ♥ 5 4
 ♦ A 8 7 4
 ♣ A 8 2



♠ K J 8 4
 ♥ A K 7 2
 ♦ 6 5
 ♣ K 9 3

♠ 9 2
 ♥ J 8 3
 ♦ Q J 3 2
 ♣ J 7 6 5

West	North	East	South
	1 ♦	Pass	1 ♥
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			

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With two 4-card Majors SOUTH should respond "up-the-line", bidding



s first.

Then, after NORTH bids 1 ♠, SOUTH has enough points to jump all the way to 4 ♠.

Deal 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 9 6 3
♥ Q 6 4
♦ A 9 6 2
♣ J 7

7
11 16
6

♠ J 5 2

♥ K 9 3

♦ T 8 7 3

♣ K 5 3



♠ 7

♥ J T 8 5 2

♦ J 4

♣ A 9 8 4 2

♠ K Q T 8 4

♥ A 7

♦ K Q 5

♣ Q T 6

West

North

East

South

3♠

Pass

1♠

Pass

All Pass

4♠ by East

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EAST has 17 points and might open 1NT. But with the 5-card Major suit she prefers

to open 1♠.

WEST has excellent ♠ support but with 11 points is not quite strong enough to insist

on reaching game. Instead he makes an invitational jump to 3♠, which EAST is strong

enough to raise to game.

Deal 3

South Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 9 5 3
♥ 7 5 3
♦ 8 4
♣ K Q 9 6

5
7 7
21

♠ 8 7
♥ T 6 4
♦ K Q T 9 6
♣ T 7 3



♠ A K 6
♥ A J 9
♦ A J 2
♣ A 8 5 2

♠ J T 4 2
♥ K Q 8 2
♦ 7 5 3
♣ J 4

West	North	East	South
Pass	3NT		2NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			

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SOUTH has a powerful hand, but 21 points is not strong enough to start with a forcing 2♣ bid.

Since he has balanced distribution he opens 2NT (20-21 points).

NORTH adds her 6 points to SOUTH's minimum and concludes they should be in game. She expects her

good



suit to be useful to NORTH in Notrump so she bids 3NT.

Deal 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ T 9 5
♥ J 4
♦ Q J 8 3
♣ K J 7 2

10
8 13
9

♠ A Q 4 2

♥ 9 7 6

♦ 7 5

♣ A 8 6 3



♠ K 8 7

♥ T 5 3

♦ A T 9 4 2

♣ Q 4

♠ J 6 3

♥ A K Q 8 2

♦ K 6

♣ T 9 5

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EAST has a solid 1



opening, 14 points and five trumps.

WEST must respond with 8 points, but cannot bid either minor suit since he needs at least

11 points to bid a new suit at the 2-level. So he bids 1NT (6-10 points).

EAST doesn't object to Notrump so she passes.

West

North

East

South

1 ♥

Pass

1NT

All Pass

1NT by West

Deal 5

North Deals
N-S Vul

♠ A 5 4
♥ J T 9
♦ A Q 4 2
♣ J 5 2

13
12 9
6

♠ K Q T 7 3

♥ A 4 2

♦ 9 7 5

♣ A 6



♠ J 9 6 2

♥ K Q 7 5

♦ 8 3

♣ T 7 4

♠ 8

♥ 8 6 3

♦ K J T 6

♣ K Q 9 8 3

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NORTH has a normal 1♠ opening bid, 14 points and five trumps.

SOUTH has good 4-card support and 7 points, so she raises to 2♠,

passed by NORTH.

SOUTH does not consider showing the



West

North

East

South

s,

1♠

Pass

2♠

All Pass

first because she knows there is a ♠ fit, and second because she doesn't have

2♠ by North

the 11 points needed to bid a new suit at the 2-level.